

[Part 1]

Interviewer: Describe our interviews and it's the transcriptions that will go into lexical analysis and etc etc etc.

Speaker: Ohh... alright sir.

Interviewer: Yeah, so I think yeah we are recording right now so I've already gotten your permission. So just for the record, I can get your permission to do this interview. All right, I mean to record this interview. So first of all, hi and how old are you right now, [Speaker]?

Speaker: So, right now I'm [20-25 years old].

Interviewer: [20-25 years old]? [20-25 years old], just finish your first week of actual work. Now so you're officially an adult now I guess making your own money and done with college.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: And how long have you been with your partner?

Speaker: Oh I've been with my partner, well we've been friends for like quite a while since [grade school].

Interviewer: Uhum. So it's around [Year]. [Year] diba?

Speaker: Yes [Y]ar} yeah that was [grade school], that's when we first met and then when we became partners like um let's say officially officially, I think it could be around [Year] like very early [Year] [Month].

Interviewer: Say that again [Year]?

Speaker: [Year], uh [Year].

Interviewer: Ah [Year]? So that's for almost [5-10] years as a couple.

Speaker: It's [5-10] years yeah.

Interviewer: You lived in [City A] kasi before you were in a dorm when you were in college but right now you're back living with your family in [City A] right?

Speaker: Right, yes right now I'm back in [City A].

Interviewer: Yeah and how many are you in the house?

Speaker: Oh we are... uh [<5] in the house right now I live with my mom and my sister, my dad is currently in our house in [City B] depending on our area there. So uh while we do visit each other, um that's generally the setup like on a typical day-to-day weekly basis right now.

Interviewer: Okay, so obviously you don't have children of your own yet.

Speaker: Yep, yep.

Interviewer: Unless you have children with other people other than—

Speaker: No no no.

Interviewer: Hahaha.

Speaker: Haha.

Interviewer: No children, no children. And uh you just started your job and can you tell me a little bit about what, what it is that you do?

Speaker: Okay so right now um so I work in [department]. I work in a [company] right now uh currently I'm in the [department] side of, um one of the services they offer um so I'm, I help [occupation], that's what I'm doing but uh I'm in a [program] right now so I'll be rotating every [6-10] months with different job responsibilities. So but right now that's what I've been doing, I've been taking up training right now I haven't done anything like uh work in that's like um... concrete work right now I'm still doing training but that's what I'm expected to do in the next couple of weeks and months.

Interviewer: So you're rotating um around various departments is that like a [occupation]?

Speaker: Yeah, it's [position].

Interviewer: It's a [position]. Wow so you're being groom to eventually be part of management.

Speaker: Yes hopefully.

Interviewer: Yeah yeah okay and so far so good right?

Speaker: Hmm so far so good. Well it's been a week, it's been a really good time but we'll see so far it's been great.

Interviewer: And what do you call [Partner]? Like how do you introduce her to people? She's my what?

Speaker: Oh I tell, I tell people that she's my girlfriend uh I address her by her first name so..like this is [Partner] she's my girlfriend.

Interviewer: So girlfriend?

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: All right. All right now uh I've heard [Partner] version of how you met what-what is your version how did you guys meet?

[Portion Redacted]

Interviewer: And [1-5 years] into it, would you say the relationship is going strong? How strongly?

Speaker: I say it's uh... I say it's going really strong. Um right now, it's definitely a little uh rougher because it's a massive adjustment you know? Uh, because well apart from covid right, uh excluding the covid years... Like in university uh she's from [University A], we're very it's still very close we'd still go on lots of dates. Uh we'd go to, we'd go to [Location] at night... And then at a nearby mall we just eat out at a bunch of cinemas. And we'd go on like random dates around [Metropolitan]. And it was really nice, and we were still very close to one another so it made going to each other very accessible.

Speaker: Right now, uh [City A] is on the other side of [Metropolitan]. I'm adjusting to work.. So um um so definitely like there's a change in let's say my schedule, change in how I should run myself, grab it like my first week, napagod talaga ako. Like up to a bunch of people um and like

you know I have to familiarize myself with the environment. It's a completely new environment meant for me after more than a decade of schooling and then get dumped into the adulting world like that. And then especially since she's still a student, right? Taking her [1st-5th] year so taking her [1st-5th] year in her double degree, double degree course right... So uh it's been an adjustment but um we've always made sure to properly communicate like oh I'm probably going to be busy here I'm probably going to be busy here. I probably won't have time for this however I can make up for doing this right. So actually like very recently that's Wednesday or Thursday, it's basta like Wednesday, yeah Wednesday I invited her out for dinner in [City] because that's where the office is. And then, yeah it was like a really nice time then I drove her back and like okay um because you know uh I have I always want to make it to happen to like constantly meet up especially while she's still in school, I'm starting work and it's like two completely different paths as compared to when we were basically on the same area for like so long right and...

Speaker: So yeah I can say that the relationship is going strong in a way that um we've been properly communicating with one another. We try to um make certain adjustments especially right now where a lot of things are changing and um I want to still accommodate temper, and she probably can she definitely feel the same way right. And then, uh so I, yeah it's been like very strong when we were together when we were like really when our paths were basically like we are the same area right, and so while I think that we're still adjusting right now I still think I could say that the relationship is quite strong.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: So we'll get there, we'll get there.

Interviewer: Very good to hear, yeah. Although sabi mo nga, right now it's going through a period of adjustment because you just left college etc. and now you live far apart so but so far so good is what you're saying. Now how would you, if you were to look at other people's relationships like your friends, your family, in your family etc., especially people your own age uh how does yours compare to most other really on average? How does it compare like when you say you're stronger than average or etc etc.? yeah.

Speaker: Compared to... Okay compared to our peers um I think I think that it's stronger than average because I feel like I know like a bunch of people who have been with their partners for like one, two, three years or even months sometimes. And although my perception can get like maybe probably a little speed right because like in our friend group, all of us have been with our partners for like I'd say a longer than average time right... So um I'd say that in terms of like in terms of.. in well... Uh I guess one indicator about relationship quality would be how long we've been together right? I'd say in that regard parang... I'd say that we're definitely stronger than average right... Um we spend lots of time together even though we're not together physically like we go on lots of discord calls or calls on Facebook messenger, especially when we have the time and privacy to do cheesy things on call haha. I so uh I think I could say that it's stronger than average but um.. I think that I feel like... Well I want to say that it's stronger than average. I don't know if it actually is because you know asymmetric information. I'm not the most active on social media... So you know like, oh what are these couples doing like oh break up like I I'm not sure if I'm like super uh machismo na tao but I think I can say that like based on what I can see so far in her—

Interviewer: Well I mean this is your personal perception right and perception doesn't necessarily everybody's perception doesn't isn't exactly the same as reality... And that's just the way it is

right but-but based on your perception it seems much stronger than the average than most other relationships that you're familiar with. As familiar as you can get with them, one you say it's because of how constantly and regularly you guys communicate...Uh sabi mo when you have privacy you say you get to speak cheesy cheesily with each other. What-what do you mean by that?

Speaker: Oh.

Interviewer: Yeah is it like kilig lambing lambing? What is that?

Speaker: Yes parang lambing lambing siya haha.

Interviewer: Okay that's something that happens regularly?

Speaker: Uh well I've... When I move back to [City A] um me and my sister don't share the same... We share, we share rooms because it's a small condo um so like there I'm limited but when we're in [City B], we have because like medyo nahihiya—

Interviewer: Haha.

Speaker: —pa ako oh my gosh... My girl has this soft na side na I don't know parang maybe haha parang yeah something like that but uhm if I do get that .. I definitely... Oh oh oh one things new nga pala it now kasi now we call in the car kasi because I solo the car and then might drive close to like an hour hour and a half and then we stay on call and then and then like that—

Interviewer: Say that again, what about the car? Oo can you repeat that I didn't quite...

Speaker: Kasi I drive to... I drive. I'm sorry. I drive to work and it's probably one of the best places I can get privacy like to talk to her and uh as like cheesy and lambing I can. Because I'm alone and then uh uh so like if we came a sort of thing that we do print like we've done like recently kasi there's not a lot of privacy in like our small condo when in Bataan our house it's a bit bigger so like you're definitely so parang ganon lang yeah.

Interviewer: Okay what sort of things do you say? Those cheesy things that you feel comfortable to say in private but you don't want other people to overhear? Can you give me an example of that?

Speaker: Um parang um...Um is this the right word, parang baby talk in a way.

Interviewer: Oh okay like do you change your voice?

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: So I definitely know... Okay yeah and I'm guessing you don't want to do that right and do a demonstration of that right now...

Speaker: No.

Interviewer: Okay um how many partners have you, is that your first official girlfriend or have you had other relationships in the past?

Speaker: She's my first. I've had crushes in the past but in terms of like relationships—.

Interviewer: Wow interesting and it's lasted this long and it's going this strongly... That's amazing yeah that's amazing okay. So you say um yours is stronger than average, it's of higher quality than average. Um what do you think personally, what for you makes for high quality relationship? You already mentioned um regular communication uh lambing noh. What do you guys do? What other things does a high quality relationship need to have for it to be perceived or judged as a high quality relationship?

Speaker: Okay for it to be like a high quality relationship, so yeah apart from like um you know communication right, lambing and then I think ano another, um like even if it's not lambing... I'd say even like quality time as well for me. Kasi um they it's nice to have like someone that you can be comfortable in your own skin in a way. So I think that's like one of them as well like when we were like together, physically with one another like oh minsan pahiga-higa lang, I'll show you this oh, I'll show you that, or like we'll come up with some weird ideas to this and activity here, go out here parang ganon. So I don't exactly know how to put that to words but I think like uh that's that's the one of them right. And then, um another thing is I think apart from communicating is also the willingness to adjust as well right. Um I especially like me I'm starting work sobrang layo ng [City A] sa [City C], kabilang dulo siya. Um so and then other thing right, sobrang nag-iiba set up namin, so like we definitely know... Like we miss we miss each other's, we miss each other's presence right, but we both know that uh this kind of has to happen because she she really wants her degree and like I really support her for that you know and then for me naman it's to well since I'm, I'm really graduated, I need um... Well I need to figure out like what kind of career that I want to have right? So um what kind of um what is the kind of adjustment we can make in where we can try to make this difference that's upward. So uh, I think the adjustment I mean is like, oh we should go out weekly at the very least or in the worst case by week right, I'll drive her, I'll drive her back [City D] to [City E], and then drive all the way back right. Uh one of those things or that we go out somewhere somewhere in um at [City F] uh and we do different activities we'd like to do with each other so uh I think that's one of that's another act so ayon.

Interviewer: So uh willingness to adjust no, to, to changes in the situation in each other's situation, and in uh, in the stage of your— the life that you're in. Uh, well you mentioned about um you should have time for each other noh. How does one know when they're devoting the right amount of time? Because obviously two people can't be together 24/7. So how do you know how much time is enough for a couple like... Is there a rule, is there a way for you to assess na we're spending the optimum the right amount of time – not not too little no how do you know it's the right amount?

Speaker: I'm doing this right now. I honestly never really thought about it.

Interviewer: Right yeah.

Speaker: I'm like oh I want to spend a lot of time with you. And bigla na lang... Oh my gosh so much like I was asked ganon or like parang I'm I feel like I'm a little bit more spontaneous in a way that I have it exactly like really thought about it. But um in terms of like right time I feel like um the right amount of time I look at for each other. Parang it feels like it should be like a weird naman to say it that way... Parang it's like a function of um trying to optimize how you want like for example iyong lambing. And then how much time you also want to like go out and do what you actually want. Because you know parang time is limited and um it should be like um at some point like maybe like I mean definitely right like being together for like so long is like definitely counterproductive to like other aspects of life. Like for example um let's say things you want to

learn your other hobbies so parang it should be like um uh like whatever is like the parang best balance of the two and then you'll see it after I think.

Interviewer: Right yeah all right. Um, what about when you said na you have that cheesy lambing ways of interacting like, if a relationship didn't have that, would that damage the quality of the relationship? It's something you have and that makes your own relationship high quality in your opinion. Now you think other people, other relationships that don't have that would probably not have that as high a quality as a result—

Speaker: Um...um I think that um I think that it's I think that it's ano parang kunware I think about it, I think that it's true parang there's a certain way that you communicate with each other na parang it's like a completely different language. But like you know parang language and the way of speaking is the best way of like expressing yourself to another person right. So parang easy easy lambing things I like another like, language na parang that's exclusive to you lang so I feel like it's, it could be like a strong indicator I feel like I need to put the cut yeah parang I think I could consider it like—

Interviewer: Okay very good now um you didn't mention anything about and not by the term but you— have you didn't say love, no, but do you think love is important in a relationship? Of course, I have to ask.

Speaker: Yes yes.

Interviewer: Yeah but uh you didn't use that word yet but I'm assuming that and you say yes it's important in your relationship. So you have a strong relationship, a high quality relationship. Do I take it you mean there is love in this relationship? Yeah yeah. How do you know that, like, what is love and where does it show? Where is it in your relationship? Very slam book yung tanong, what is love. But yeah it's one of the concepts in life that everybody assumes everybody else understands but if you had to verbalize it well, what is it anyway? And you say you have this love in your relationship. How do you know what it is?

Speaker: Parang.. it's for me parang I think it's the willingness to add someone or something else it's so important to you in your life that you're willing to um that you're willing to... uhhh...do some things to accommodate for it. I think for me parang ganon siya.

Interviewer: Okay.. So that's what love is like letting someone into your life.

Speaker: Mhm.

Interviewer: —And adjusting to make room for that someone.

Speaker: Uhum.

Interviewer: That's what love is, yeah. And why, why would anybody if I was an alien and I think why would anyone want to do that? That's so tiring that it takes effort right? Parang um like here I am living my life and then I have to make room for somebody else. Why would I do that? Why would somebody want to do that?

Speaker: Hmm... I wouldn't tell anyone and because ultimately you know even um even if you'd make space even if you'd adjust you know, you'd be happier as an end result and you know you'd feel more fulfilled.

Interviewer: Right okay. Yeah because it's worth it this is what you're saying?

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Right okay yeah because it's worth it this is what you're saying it's worth the trouble.

Speaker: Yeah .

Interviewer and Speaker: *(unclear overlapping of conversation)*

Speaker: That's weird...parang weird ng word na ginagamit ko kasi icon cause my icon degree pero parang ganon siya.

Interviewer: Ahh ahh what's that, say that again?

Speaker: Sorry parang I just realized I've been a little weird, ang weird ng word kasi parang lumalabas yong parang icon degree in a way.

Interviewer: Ahh hahaha that's fine that's fine.

Speaker: Kasi I can grasp..

Interviewer: That's fine, that's fine.

Speaker: So yeah perfect yan, that's how ano—

Interviewer: It's gonna come out and it's fine that is exactly one of your it's, it's nice that I get to interview you coming from this area of expertise and from this kind of job training. So this is the way your mind works and that's one of the contributions that you have and to the interview you know so yeah... It's worth the effort. It is some it takes effort, it causes some trouble to accommodate someone in your, in your life but you're saying but it's worth it right?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Because you end up being happier—

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Than you were before you made that adjustment. Yeah and that's what love is for you... That's what love is being willing to do to go to make the effort to let someone in your life.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Yeah alright uhm and you said yeah. Unless you have that, sabi mo nga kanina na one of the things that make your relationship strong that you're willing to adjust no. So you're saying uh that's how important it is unless you're willing to do that then you're not going to have a good quality of a relationship.

Speaker: Yep.

Interviewer: Yeah okay um so uh does it mean then that you and um [Partner] are both willing to do these to make these efforts to accommodate each other in each other's lives?

Speaker: Yeah well if we weren't, I don't think we'd be together it's like—

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: COVID happened so like oh no, we can't, we couldn't visit each other for like a really long time what can we do like oh would you be open to like be on call for like entire afternoon or like—

Interviewer: So like you see that you need to (*the speaker also speaks inaudibly*). You see that she is making...just like you, she also makes an effort to make adjustments and etc etc. Right apart from that um how else do you see that she loves you apart from that is there any other way that you sense love from her?

Speaker: Hmm..oh so apart from like willing to adjust right, I think...

Interviewer: Meron po ba only if there are, you don't have to force yourself—

Speaker: You know romantic gestures for me like, especially like ano start of the relationship right ahh she writes songs, she performs songs. Ako kasi it's like I wish I developed some sort of artistic talent for myself. I really want to reciprocate that ahm so yeah. And then um so she does those things for me right, she's um constantly supportive rin of my of like any decisions that I make like, for example, um other ways I spend lots of quality time together. And then finally sure, like ano, like um needs that's like that can be fulfilled by each other like can be met sort of in a way parang gan'on. So yeah I think those are the aspects so that's why I can see like love.

Interviewer: Yeah so all these things all these things tell you that oh this person loves me.

Speaker: Uhum.

Interviewer: Okay, very good, all right. Um what about challenges in the relationship? Every everybody has every relationship, uh gets its challenges no uh... What would you say those are for the two of you? Well, you already talked about... yeah you already talked about this is one challenge this big adjustment period is one such example tama ba?

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Yeah that's a cha... Are there anything, are there any other things uh in the five years that you've been together that have ended up, that have ended up being a challenge for you to maintain a strong relationship?

Speaker: Mhm uh I see their external factors. Um I think that uh like, for example. I think my parents like they were wondering like why I got into our relationship so early parang ganon. So yeah.

Interviewer: That's one.

Speaker: Yeah it's one of them, mhm. Uh I see their external factors, um I think that uh like for example I think my in play there and I think that became a challenge right so parang minsan like especially like [1-5] years ago?

Interviewer: Yeah.

Speaker: Parang nahiya-hiya pa ako magpaalam, for example right because I'm still dependent on them. So um I think that's like picking a challenge especially like in the past years. Ngayon it's like less of a challenge but I think it was important for me to like parang say that uh that was one like one of the challenges right um yeah yeah.

Interviewer: Did they give you a hard time when you said, when you announced that oh I have a girlfriend now they weren't very supportive of that?

Speaker: Um they probably they never explicitly said it naman. But like uh parang I could tell us like 'yong energy is a little off.

Interviewer: Really? Why, what gave you that idea?

Speaker: Uh ano lang, parang when it talks to each other parang it's not exactly as lively like if like topics like that are brought up. So parang I got a little discouraged to talk about the relationship with them like in the past years right now it's uh getting better pero yeah ayon.

Interviewer: But oh that's very interesting it's like they weren't uh they didn't approve so much of you being in a relationship and you think it's because of the age of how young you were?

Speaker: Um I think so yeah.

Interviewer: Yeah okay and it's only that, it's only that it's just they thought you were young at least that's what you're thinking uh oh maybe because they think I'm too young—

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Yeah oh so that was a challenge. So you okay yeah yeah, was [Partner] aware of that?

Speaker: Parang she could tell as well because like... like I've been like um parang especially I have had a hard time getting approvals like going out.

Interviewer: Kasi there are time that hindi ka papayagan to go out ganon ba?

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Okay, how long did that last 'yong... You have pero sabi mo just this week. It's still there. It's still the hesitation from you na nahihirapan kapang magpaalam because you know they're not happy that you're going out on a date, well they're not totally happy that ...

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: ...You're not totally happy, that's interesting.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: So hanggang ngayon pala do you think how has that changed at all from the start to to right now?

Speaker: Oh, it changed they're more open.

Interviewer: They're more open. Like, how much open are they now, sa tingin mo compared to let's say compared to four or five years ago?

Speaker: Oh they won't stop me now.

Interviewer: Yeah, say that again.

Speaker: Parang they won't stop me now and then the sometimes they'll ask kumusta, kumusta naman parang ganon.

Interviewer: Meron naman, there's change there's a change all right. So just to be sure, it's whatever is making them not give their total approval or for them not being totally happy, is it the mere fact that you're going out with someone and it's not that because it's not me?

Speaker: Hmmm, I think that well I think that made well. I think I'll just use like what I think nalang but mainly change because they think like oh you're parang you're committing yourself you're committing yourself. Parang around you're still... don't you want to explore a bit more? Parang ganon. It's like parang ganon like not madalas but like one of the things I recall and like no quite happy you know and then um I'm quite happy so far and like I'll stand by with my decision. So with my decision to be with her right, so yeah that was so one of the things and I think that they were um not necessarily because that... you know because like... For example, one of the reasons why they don't abuse because I know it's bad you're right. I don't think it's that I think it's more of ahh parang because they were like a little hesitant parang they weren't able to willing to like... super like get to know her parang in a way so I think that um whether or not because it's [Partner] I'm not too sure because ah parang there was a time that parang like they didn't want to super get to know her parang ganon.

Interviewer: Because you attempted to introduce them and they weren't very open to the idea—

Speaker: Yeah parang....ganon lang it's sort of—

Interviewer: But they've met her?

Speaker: Yeah they met her and uh she was with us during my graduation.

Interviewer: So you're saying you're saying no... I don't think it's [Partner] specifically, it's that they don't like the idea of you going out with someone and stay committing to anyone it doesn't matter if it's [Partner] or another person they just aren't all for the idea of you committing to somebody at this age?

Speaker: Yeah agad parang ganon.

Interviewer: So are you saying that they'd be more happy if you dated several different people than being in one relationship for this long is that what you're saying ba?

Speaker: Um I honestly don't know (haha) but feel ko there might be some element in truth to that because like oh you're so young parang ganon.

Interviewer: You should be going out with different people yeah you know so you think how much younger is your sister compared to you?

Speaker: She's [1-5] years younger.

Interviewer: [1-5] years so you think she's gonna go through the same thing that your parents won't be happy if she starts like going—

Speaker: Ohh honestly the parang... there's a gendered aspect to that parang they want her to not even like date until after graduating.

Interviewer: Ohh bawal.

Speaker: But they also said no but if you want to date like uh... we can't stop naman cause you know and because you know that's what she also said because you know it's part of life parang ganon.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: But like I recall that there were some parang not really threats but like yeah.

Interviewer: Yeah okay yeah that explains something no let's see um.... So any other challenge in your relationship specifically aside from the parents not giving their total approval or seeming not to give their total approval? And it's kind of obvious to you it's kind of obvious to [Partner]... Um and it's obvious to your sister then... that they wouldn't approve of her going out and committing to someone. Uh, anything else aside from the parents that proves to be a challenge to your relationship?

Speaker: Say there's an economic aspect because you know um we want to go 10 more dates but una, like we lack time aspect like and lalo ngayon of course monetary aspect we're like young right, course college real college student stereotype that's true.

Interviewer: 'Yong the money aspect, the time aspect you know... before it was easy you lived in the same building and you both go to college so time was very much on your side back then.

Speaker: Very much so.

Interviewer: So the finance, the financial part ba, is it less of a challenge now, more of the same pa rin, student life para ikaw, you financially, you still feel like a student gan'on ba?

Speaker: Um back then, I think medyo (*inaudible*) ngayon wala pa akong paycheck eh.

Interviewer: Right right yeah so student parin ngayon.

Speaker: But what I'm gonna deliver is like one of the first things that I'll do.

Interviewer: Yeah when I get like my financial wise, it's how, has it been constant, you know how challenging it was financially? It's been constant for the past five years, would you say more or less?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Constant siya so there was no time that it became less of a challenge or more of a challenge? More or more or less it's been a constant it's been presenting a constant amount of challenge to you?

Speaker: Uhm yeah lalo like dependent on allowance.

Interviewer: Because you feel like you don't have enough money to go out as much as you want gano'n ba?

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: So ah frequency frequency, the frequency of going out yeah. All right, anything else aside from uh nothing, uh limited amount of time, limited amount of resources, money, no financial resources and then 'yon nga not enough approval from the parents... Meron pa ba in terms of challenges?

Speaker: Challenges?... It was our first relationship right, um so that was definitely a challenge. Like, in start like how are we gonna go about this? Like are we sure we're being good to each other parang ganon.

Interviewer: Yeah. Oh and how do you know, ayon nga actually I ask you a little bit how do you know that in fact you, you look back and you now see now... Oh that was a challenge pala eh parang nangangapa ka at the start. Are we doing relationships "right", right? Are we.. 'yon sinasabi mo no and how did you end up deciding whether or not you're doing it "right"?

Speaker: I think it comes with introspection like parang um... sometimes we think about what we did like, let's say met the argument, let's say maybe I did something unfavorable or maybe she did uh. So parang I think it also comes with a retrospective and thinking about what yong parang and then thinking what happened is like an aspect and then figuring out what you want to do after. So parang I think that's how I can put it... like like ..ano ba like...wait sorry nawala yong chain of thought ko what's the question?

Interviewer: It's okay. Uh, how do you know you're doing that, you're doing it right? Kasi sabi mo one of the challenges one of the challenges was, am I uh, sabi mo i-try ko i-recall the exact word did you use ah parang is this good for me?

Speaker: Oh yeah.

Interviewer: Am I doing what I'm supposed to be doing in this relationship and how do you decide, how do you decide if you're doing it right?

Speaker: 'Yon nga I... yeah you na like introspection and then like thinking about um what it may have for like the future or like any consequences it may have. Like right now so parang gano'n sometimes I just give it some thought... Parang we have to process like tama ba 'to? Tapos what's supposed to happen now? And then parang it's nice that we've communicated like so well like over the years and parang ayon nga like uhm ultimately what ended up happening is like oh it's um really nice to like deal with each other and I love her you know she loves me as well and ayon nga even though we're like presented with like cosmetic information about whether or not they were like we don't know everything... Parang I don't hope to let people boil us down to that.

Interviewer: Well okay you mentioned that sometimes you'd have arguments right um, how often would they happen in your own relationship do they come up a lot or not not often?

Speaker: Rare actually it's very rare.

Interviewer: Very rare, interesting. Wow, like in the five years that you've been together off the top of your head how many arguments have you had?

Speaker: Okay there was one major one, [Year], um uh there was one major one in [Year] because um, um where like I think malala siya I think um... that was the most notable argument that we had I like wasn't even like an argument... We were just ano trying to communicate but we felt how like um at that time how I hurt her, uh because of um yeah because like we were out in ano... Uh I was out in another country for our school project thing and then parang for a school presentation for some research, for a research paper, and then parang there was a time that I was like very responsive on the phone. And then she wasn't feeling that great at that time and then parang um parang I guess at that time um I was probably um not noticing my phone right, I've been ignoring her because I've been focusing on what's happening physically because we

were doing that on chat. Parang and ayon nga like that's where ah she got mad at me. So it was like not even necessarily an argument. Actually, it was just more of a fight we don't even we don't argue, we don't think we argue. We just talk things through but I think yeah yeah like we really try to talk about talaga. Yeah that was the most major one I can honestly think of.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Speaker: The rest are like...

Interviewer: The other ones are not even arguments in your opinion because you always just talk about things and are open to each other so not that's very and we would, if people say well some people would say, that's impossible there's no relationship where no arguments and what would you say to those people?

Speaker: Um parang that's not even true I don't think it's true because um when you argue parang you let your emotions get the best of you.

Interviewer: And that doesn't happen to you guys, that rarely happens to you guys—

Speaker: Yeah parang... I've always wanted I always like to reflect as well and I always want to thank before I speak so well for me for like I like speaking on like my side so in terms of like that aspect like parang I definitely do my best to like avoid quarrels or arguments and like I think even outside of my relationship with [Partner] I really, I'm really not an argumentative like sort of like I'm not super confrontational in that way where I'd rather set to be different means right—

Interviewer: Right so you think it's more because of the kind of person you are that's why as me as far as your side is concerned that's why you don't have much arguments it's because of the type of personality that you have that you think before you speak that you're you're in control of your emotions and all that—

Speaker: Oh yeah I think that's one aspect parang it there's also like multiple aspects as well I think—

Interviewer: Okay now a while ago you said that uh, how do you know your relationship is good for you, uh so I asked you how do you know that then diba parang sabi mo at the beginning that was one of the challenges. It's like oh um did I do the right thing getting into this relationship and did I choose the right person? So ikaw how do you know kasi sabi mo nga love is like letting someone into your life and it's worth all the trouble because and we do it because you end up as a happier person. How do you, you personally how do you know that this relationship is good for you how do you know that you're happier now with inside this relationship than you would be if you were not in it how how do you know—

Speaker: Oh, oh think that um I think of um how I feel when we're together I think of all of the days we've gone through it's like oh let's go here parang I like I get to do things na parang that I wouldn't have done otherwise uh I changed in a way like as a person like there are aspects of myself that have changed because I've been with her parang ganon and then um—

Interviewer: You mean like—

Speaker: Oh like how have you changed as a person because of this relationship I was more reserved like quiet more quiet but then parang I um parang she actually helped me like open up like a bit more

Interviewer: To her or to everybody?

Speaker: To honestly to her to both to her and everybody.

Interviewer: So you're both open to them—

Speaker: Yeah so while i like while I'm like I'm introverted definitely um well I do say I like processing things I tend to like give it to myself so it's like uh parang..she taught me parang is like um um I don't she's taught me like um like a bunch of stuff as well like she's um parang, pa'no ba 'to sabihin it's like she's definitely helped me like really become a better person talaga like parang in general I think um parang—

Interviewer: Although like when you say you're a better person one example is you think oh I'm more open to other people I'm less introverted now ...ano pa like how do you how are you able to say in the end na oh I'm a better person now why, why do you say that?

Speaker: Um huh wait lang I think that in a way like um um parang(haha) um it's like yeah kasi it's like ano it's like hmm I've... parang in my mind I've never exactly thought of this but parang I know that um this decision i have like it's like staying with her like right now it's like a thing that I want to be continuing on doing—

Interviewer: Um you just know that yeah yeah you just know that and you know that this relationship is good for you it's changed you for the better has it it has it changed you for the worst in any way at all or lahat positive changes—

Speaker: Um parang it didn't parang I don't think it's really an influence ay I think it doesn't expose some parts like oh ang clingy ko pala and stuff so—

Interviewer: Oh okay right.

Speaker: Parang gano'n hindi naman na parang sa first pero I think sa realizations naman and stuff—

Interviewer: You got to know yourself better, this is okay all right and as far as being a better person it's it's hard for you to articulate how but you just feel that you're a better person because of this relationship um yeah okay okay now how about [Partner] your partner do you think she's changed from the past five years she's a different person now than she was before and in what way—

Speaker: Uh I think that she was like a little bit more parang um her outlook of like the world and things in general were like a bit more negative dati and she's like explicitly mentioned that because ako kasi as a social science din ako I feel like in [field] sa [field] so [field] sa [field] and like one of the things she's mentioned like that is like oh this world is not that good to live in parang ganon and like because like imagine and I would talk about different topics with her and say oh i guess things can be changed for the better parang gan'n and I think in that aspect it became a little bit it's like ano she change in that way um for me it's like I think that's one of the things that has changed um other things that have changed I think we became a lot more mature like emotionally is that puberty is not because we were together is it because of puberty it could be both naman pero—

Interviewer: But yeah—

Speaker: We were both people naman—

Interviewer: How do you what makes you say that you're more mature now both of you sabi mo no that both of you are more mature now just because you turned into [16-20] somethings ganon ba 'yon why do you say that mas mature kana now or both of you are more mature now than before why do you say that?

Speaker: Parang it process things better okay our thoughts and emotions and uh things we feel better I think yeah i think that way we became more mature our fights became with like so much less like not really fights but like you know just problems like things we have it's much less now parang I think dati-dati I think in that way?

Interviewer: All right now a while ago you said that one of the factors that you can count for a good relationship is uh you're able to be yourself tama ba?

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Do I remember that you said that you're you're okay to show yourself and all that. So uh and you feel like that's something that you're able to do in this relationship now?

Speaker: Yes yes.

Interviewer: You use that [Partner] is supportive uh you are supportive of her and she is supportive of your decisions also that's that's right?

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: So um I would assume na you feel a sense of safety in this relationship because yeah—

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Okay like um are there any stuff at all that you don't feel safe enough to discuss with her to open up to her is there any side of you that you don't feel comfortable enough sharing with her? Do you have secrets from each other well on your side I don't know about her side but from your side are there any secrets you feel like you can't divulge at this point yet may ganon ba or are you totally open like how, how open how much of an open book are you to her?

Speaker: Um I have um well kasi diba I'm a little bit more reserved so like it took me a little bit of time to open up like uh by open up i mean like um i won't like there was a time like value when I was younger I won't say things unless explicitly asked for like so while parang I'm like hindi naman ko parang open book kailangan lang buksan lang ng konti.

Interviewer: Hahaha.

Speaker: Parang ganon pero I'm totally open with her.

Interviewer: Pero before, sabi mo yeah there's there's certain information you won't volunteer but if you if you get asked then you will answer truthfully tama ba?

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: So you feel like do you feel like pretty much you can say anything to her there's not no topic it's off limits no no aspect of yourself is off limits or it's too private for you although sabi

nga nila we always everybody always has that private side and that's it's fine is it okay that couples have secrets from each other too is that okay or is that not good.

Speaker: I think that... um well I think that if it's communicated upon that it's like oh there maybe these are some things that I want to keep private and then if they have to be okay with it or not parang ganon.

Interviewer: What, do you have any phone things?

Speaker: Right now no she can go through my phone whenever—

Interviewer: Does she?

Speaker: No naman that's so weird kasi to do what's like honestly I wouldn't.

Interviewer: But if you wanted to you'd have totally no problem with that.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Very interesting so I—

Speaker: But like I would find it weird—

Interviewer: Yeah okay yeah all right.

Speaker: Baka 'yong work lang is (unclear)... like ano ba pinag se-search neto.

Interviewer: Yeah yeah.

Speaker: Parang gan'on but we're totally open.

Interviewer: You can't imagine anything she could possibly ask you that you you wouldn't want to answer truthfully.

Speaker: Parang gan'on yeah I think that's how best put kaysa naman weird na example na binigay ko.

Interviewer: Yeah that's amazing that's amazing um let's see oh I forgot to open one file that I want to ask you it's just a scale but uh hang on huh let's see.

Speaker: Can I ask how much longer pala—

Interviewer: Um it's gonna take about siguro 30 minutes siguro.

Speaker: 30 minutes.

Interviewer: Or we can continue another time if you prefer.

Speaker: I think I think I'm being called na kasi eh.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: I'm really sorry it's okay we only have ano—

Interviewer: Its okay we only have let's see we only have about seven more questions actually but if you have to go now that's totally fine and we can continue another time—

Speaker: Yeah yeah I think yeah I think continue but uh another time nalang.

Interviewer: O sige sige.

Speaker: Really sorry because like—

Interviewer: It's okay, it's okay ah, because you at the family event right right, sige sige so should you just tell me when? I mean you don't have to tell me now you just let me know when—

Speaker: Okay, its likely to be Saturday I think.

Interviewer: Next Saturday na.

Speaker: If okay lang, if okay lang.

Interviewer: That's okay that's okay.

Speaker: Yeah next saturday, I'm so sorry.

Interviewer: It's okay its okay ganon talaga, well thank you thank you for yeah thank you thank you for for the hour you've been gone from the party too long.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Sige sige.

Speaker: Okay thank you [Interviewer].

Interviewer: Thank you so much .

Speaker: But you're okay you're okay to finish the interview next time.

Interviewer: Yes.

Speaker: All right oh sige okay thank you thank you bye enjoy your party bye thank you.

[PART 2]

Interviewer: Okay. So we're recording now and you are allowing us to record this last part of our interview, right?

Speaker: yes

Interviewer: Yeah. Thank you, [Speaker]. So just to recap what we talked about before we started the recording. Okay. One is you said you put it at 9, that your partner listens to you, really listens to you, and that it's usually responsive to your needs. You put those two things at 9, because

whatever factors, whenever there are times that you may not feel like she was listening to you and that she was responsive to you, it's only because of external factors and things that she cannot help. And so you would put them at 9 is what you said, right? Yeah. Okay. And you did say that as far as sexual activity is concerned, it used to be once a week back when you were living in the same building when you were still both in college. And it became once a month nalang when you graduated and moved back to [City A] since [Month].

Speaker: Yeah

Interviewer: And that if you had it your way, it would still be once a week.

Speaker: Yeah

Interviewer: Tama ba, But it would still be once a week?

Speaker: Yeah

Interviewer: Not more often than once a week.

Speaker: Oh, yeah, I think it could be more-

Interviewer: . Okay. Yeah. Pero so what is ...kung ikaw ang tatanungin? What is the ideal? What is the ideal? Like, all things being equal and she'd be a willing party. She'd have the same drive as you and the same excitement as you. What would be the ideal frequency for you?

Speaker: Maybe twice.

Interviewer: Oh, twice a week would be just about the ideal for you.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Yeah, okay. All right. So right now, definitely far from ideal, but it cannot be helped. So that kind of cushions the blow to you because you know, this is because of circumstances in life and not because of things that are internal in each of you or in your relationship, right?

Speaker: Ahuh.

Interviewer: Yeah. And the next thing I was asking you is I'll share it again. This screen na sabi natin. Ah how satisfied are you in your relationship? And you said you said you're very satisfied, right?

Speaker: Yes. Yes.

Interviewer: Yes. Okay. Now I want to show you this. But before I show you that um, I think I just want to reiterate that you are very satisfied in your relationship because based on all your answers a while ago, everything, all the things that all the different ways you describe your relationships are near perfect. Parang everything you can ask for, almost everything you can ask for in this relationship already, which is that it's loving and it's a safe relationship and this effort coming from both parties to keep it strong.

Speaker: Ahumm, yeah

Interviewer: Is there anything else I missed on why you regard this relationship as very satisfying for you?

Speaker: I think you got pretty much the points and also pretty much the points why it's also not completely like based on my previous answers.

Interviewer: So right—

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: And not completely because of things that you guys because of the circumstances in life.

Speaker: Ahumm.

Interviewer: You being employed, you living away and all those and starting on a new job.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Okay. Now I'm very satisfied and your satisfaction mode, I'm sorry, completely satisfied. Let's see. Satisfied. So if we're completely satisfied, ayan, kung nandito tayo sa completely satisfied. These are like finer, finer demarcations within that satisfaction. Yeah. Among people who are very satisfied with this relationship, where would you be? Like how far away from 10 would you be? Because these are like more graded intervals than kanina because if I'll show you this, it's just very satisfied, somewhat satisfied. So because you're very satisfied, ah definitely you won't be at 10, right? You won't be at 10. But are you kind of a nine very satisfied or a six very satisfied or a five very satisfied? Where would you put it?

Speaker: I'd say seven very satisfied right now or eight.

Interviewer: Seven or eight very satisfied right now. That's close to 10.

Speaker: Yeah. Yeah. I guess a seven

Interviewer: Yeah. A seven. A seven. So that close to 10 or that far from 10 depending on how you want to look at it noh, yeah. Now um, pinag isipan mo seven and not eight? what what made you move to seven and not eight.

Speaker: Parang 'yong wording, not at all satisfied like I guess just the wording. And then um I decided to clean it a little bit lower because you know of the different external factors lang talaga yeah

Interviewer: Ah just to be clear, 'yong external factors ba na mentioned na natin lahat? Or is there something you haven't mentioned?

Speaker: That's all.

Interviewer: That's all talaga. Now, let's see. This is actually our last question already.

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: Is there anything when you went into the relationship, do you have any expectations that you have not yet met? Like before going into this relationship, people usually have an idea of, oh, this is how I imagine this relationship to go, and this is how I want it to go, and this is how I hope it would go. So you have those kinds of expectations. Meron pabang expectations that have not yet been fulfilled so far?

Speaker: I absolutely came into no expectation. As someone like na medyo clueless talaga, someone like who works and it works parang ganon. Then well after that, it's just a process like figuring it out right and then until it reached this point, so I guess like if the assumption is the expectation was that uh I had virtually no expectation, apart from like maybe some cheesy movie cliches, which I knew were cheesy in the first place, right?

Interviewer: Hahaha

Speaker: Um I guess apart from that, even if I do say not, parang I have no super wild out of there expectation. Parang hmm...It's not like I can't say that.

Interviewer: You can't say that you did not have expectations?

Speaker: Yeah, parang gano'n yeah... like, oh, this would be like, being with her would be really nice. But it's like ano sorry medyo inaantok na ako

Interviewer: Okay lang (while speaker talks inaudibly) But what you're saying is that you tried very hard to set no expectations when you started this relationship?

Speaker: Yeah, because of how clueless it really was and then just figured it out parang ganon.

Interviewer: You're saying you tried very hard not to set expectations, but you know you did have some expectations.

Speaker: Parang ganon yeah

Interviewer: And those expectations ba na meet naba lahat ng expectations na 'yon.

Speaker: I think so, yeah.

Interviewer: Wala kanang sa back of your mind? Oh, parang we haven't done this yet but oh, this hasn't happened in our relationship yet. Wala na wala na?

Speaker: Yeah, at this stage in our life, parang like, yeah.

Interviewer: So you're the relationship and you in this relationship are right where you thought you wouldn't be at this point.

Speaker: Ahumm.

Interviewer: All right, very good. Oh, siges so ah thank you so much for that, [Speaker]. You can sleep in a little bit. Let's end the interview here. Congratulations and thank you again for taking this time to talk to us. And ah before we end, I wanted to talk to you about the data sharing parang. I just want to get your approval for you have two options on how we share your data, we can either share. Unang-una you're surely going to be anonymized. None of the data will be traced to your actual identity. And for data sharing and for storage, parang the transcript portions can be shared, none of which can be identified to you, or are you okay even if we shared the entire transcript and not just portions of the transcript? In both cases, you're de-identified, so which one are you more comfortable with?

Speaker: I think I'm more comfortable with the slightly more censored transcript.

Interviewer: Like just portions and not the entire thing. All right.

Speaker: Yeah

Interviewer: Thank you. Thank you very much. So for the record, ah you'll be up for transcript portions being shared and can be read by other researchers. So these are for not for public and naman siya just by other researchers and you're okay with option one.

Speaker: Yeah

Interviewer: All right. So thank you. Thank you. I'll just write your thank you email again. ah you'll get that from me and I will ask you if you can nominate another person that maybe your partner doesn't know, not to be interviewed, but can lead us to another couple who we can interview. So you'll give us a nominator, not an interview week.

Speaker: Okay

Interviewer: Parang I'll put nalang in my email.

Speaker: Alright okay

Interviewer: Yeah. Is there anything else you wanna ask or you want to say before we end? Then before you go to sleep?

Speaker: Uhh maybe if I think of any, I'll just email back.

Interviewer: Okay. Yeah. No need, no need to pressure yourself. Sige, thank you [Speaker]. Thank you very much and keep in touch through email.

Speaker: Yeah. Thank you so much kita-kita narin soon

Interviewer: Haha Yeah. Bye-bye. Thank you. Bye-bye.

Speaker: Bye-bye.